Hikaru Kawarazaki

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University College London

Placement Director: Professor Attila Lindner a.lindner@ucl.ac.uk
Graduate Administrator: Daniella Harper daniella.harper@ucl.ac.uk

References

Professor **Imran Rasul**
Department of Economics
University College London
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Professor **Áureo de Paula**
Department of Economics
University College London
a.paula@ucl.ac.uk

Professor **Monica Costa-Dias**
School of Economics
University of Bristol
monica.costa-dias@bristol.ac.uk

Professor **Emily Owens**
Department of Criminology, Law, and Society
University of California, Irvine
egowens@uci.edu

Education and Academic Appointments

Institute for Fiscal Studies — London, UK
Postdoctoral Fellow — 2025 –current

University College London — London, UK
PhD in Economics — 2021 –2025

University College London — London, UK
MRes in Economics — 2020 –2021

University of Tokyo — Tokyo, Japan
M.A. Economics — 2017 –2019

University of Tokyo — Tokyo, Japan
B.A. Economics — 2013 –2017

Fields of Interest

Economics of Education, Economics of Crime, and Labor Economics

Job Market Paper

When Trouble Travels: Peer Effects of Criminal Exposure in Schools
A child's peers are an important determinant of their performance at school. While a large literature documents the adverse effects of exposure to disruptive peers on educational outcomes, little is known about the impact of being exposed to a peer with a criminal background. Using rich administrative

data linking criminal justice and education records for nearly the entire population of school students in England, I study whether and to what extent criminal behavior spreads within schools through exposure to juvenile offenders. I exploit the plausibly exogenous timing of school transfers by students with a criminal record and find that exposure increases an exposed student's probability of starting a criminal career by 12.9% within four months of the transfer, with effects persisting for three years. These peer effects generate approximately 20 million pounds in social costs, equivalent to 5% of the total social cost of youth crime in England. The effects vary substantially across school characteristics, which means that reassigning transferring offenders across schools could reduce the volume of crime induced by peer exposure by 36% under reasonable assumptions. Exposure also reduces educational attainment. Approximately one-third of this decline reflects a direct effect of exposure, while the remaining two-thirds operate through the exposed student's subsequent engagement in criminal behavior.

Publication

Sawada, Y., Mahmud, M., Seki, M., & Kawarazaki, H. (2024). Fighting the learning crisis in developing countries: A randomized experiment of self-learning at the right level. ***Economic Development and Cultural Change***, *72*(4), 1893–1921.

Kawarazaki, H. (2023). Early childhood education and care: Effects after half a century and their mechanisms. ***Journal of Population Economics***, *36*(4), 2725–2797.

Kawarazaki, H., Mahmud, M., Sawada, Y., & Seki, M. (2023). Haste makes no waste: Positive peer effects of classroom speed competition on learning. ***Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics***, *85*(4), 755–772.

Research Papers

Prolific Juvenile Offenders (2026)
with Sarah Cattan, Monica Costa-Dias, and Imran Rasul

The Schooling System and Teen Crime: New Evidence on Gender Difference from Administrative Data from England (2026)
with Sarah Cattan, Monica Costa-Dias, and Imran Rasul

Youth Crime in the Era of School Takeovers. Evidence from London Secondary School Academies (2026)
with Emma Duchini, Stephen Machin, and Victor Lavy

Publication

Sawada, Y., Mahmud, M., Seki, M., & Kawarazaki, H. (2024). Fighting the learning crisis in developing countries: A randomized experiment of self-learning at the right level. ***Economic Development and Cultural Change***, *72*(4), 1893–1921.

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Kawarazaki, H., Mahmud, M., Sawada, Y., & Seki, M. (2023). Haste makes no waste: Positive peer effects of classroom speed competition on learning. ***Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics***, *85*(4), 755–772.

Policy Reports

Fighting the learning crisis with self-learning at the right level (2026), VoxDev
with Minhaj Mahmud, Mai Seki, Yasuyuki Sawada, and Kazuma Takakura

Other Employment

International Monetary Fund — Washington, D.C., USA
Intern — 2024

Asian Development Bank — Manila, Philippines
Consultant — 2020

Asian Development Bank — Manila, Philippines
Intern — 2019

Teaching

Teaching Assistant at University College London

- Topics in Household Economics — 2023-2025
  Professor: Valerie Lechene
- Quantitative Economics and Econometrics — 2021-2023
  Professors: Kirill Borusyak, Dennis Kristensen, Daniel Lewis, and Áureo de Paula

Teaching Assistant at University of Tokyo

- Econometrics (Graduate) — 2019–2020
  Professors: Hidehiko Ichimura and Katsumi Shimotsu
- Development Economics (Graduate) — 2019
  Professor: Yasuyuki Sawada
- Econometrics (Undergraduate) — 2018–2019
  Professors: Hidehiko Ichimura and Katsumi Shimotsu
- Computational Methods for Econometrics — 2018–2019
  Instructor
- Math Camp — 2018
  Instructor
- Development Economics (Undergraduate) — 2017–2019
  Professors: Yasuyuki Sawada, Takeshi Aida, Hiroyuki Yamada
- Seminar (Development Economics) — 2016–2017
  Professor: Yasuyuki Sawada

Research Grants

- The Japan Center for Economic Research (JPY 700,000) 2026–2027
- Uehiro Foundation on Ethics and Education (JPY 600,000) 2026–2027
- Shiho Kyokai (JPY 300,000) 2025–2026
- Shiho Kyokai (JPY 400,000) 2024–2025
- Uehiro Foundation on Ethics and Education (JPY 600,000) 2024–2025
- Suntory Foundation (JPY 1,000,000) 2024–2025
- Economic and Social Research Council Studentship (GBP 2,250) 2021–2024

Scholarships and Awards

- Best Paper Award at Essen Health Conference 2026
- Economic and Social Research Council Studentship (MPhil/PhD) 2021–2024
- Japan-IMF Scholarship Program for Advanced Studies 2020–2022
- Japan Student Services Organization, Graduate Scholarship for Degree Seeking Students (MRes) 2020–2021
- Research Fellow (DC2), Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JPSP) 2020
- CREPE Trainee (Scholarship Student) at Center for Research and Education in Program Evaluation (CREPE), the University of Tokyo 2017–2020

Presentations

- **2026:** National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies, Institute for Fiscal Studies, European Association of Young Economists, Centre for Economic Performance-Becker Friedman Institute for Economics at the University of Chicago Conference on the Economics of Crime and Justice, Essen Health Conference, European Society for Population Economics, Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars, Workshop on Labour and Family Economics, Kyoto Summer Workshop on Applied Economics, Royal Economic Society, Workshop on the Economics of Risky Behavior, European Association of Labour Economists Conference, Newcastle University, The Network Science and Economics Conference, University College London, Applied Econometrics Conference, Institute for Social and Economic Research at the University of Essex
- **2025:** Sophia University, Workshop on Education Economics and Policy, World Congress of the Econometric Society, Otaru University of Commerce, Royal Economic Society, University College London, Institute for Fiscal Studies,
- **2024:** University of Tokyo, IZA/ECONtribute, International Monetary Fund, University College London, Institute for Fiscal Studies
- **2023:** University of Tokyo, Econometric Society European Winter Meeting, National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies, University College London, University of Mannheim
- **2022:** Asian and Australasian Society of Labour Economics Conference, Institute for Fiscal Studies
- **2021:** HCEO-NES-CREC Virtual Summer School on Socioeconomic Inequality, Japanese Association of Development Economics
- **2020:** Otaru University of Commerce

- **2019:** Asian and Australasian Society of Labour Economics 2019 Conference, Japanese Association of Development Economics, Asian Development Bank, University of the Philippines, Japanese Association of Development Economics, Otaru University of Commerce, Hitotsubashi University, Japan Economic Association Semi-annual Meeting, University of Tokyo
- **2015:** Korea-Japan Inter University Conference

Other

- **Service:** Referee for Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics
- **Software:** Stata, R, Python, Matlab, Fortran, LaTeX
- **Languages:** Japanese (native), English (fluent), and Italian (intermediate)

Updated on October 11, 2026